

Dave Yarwood

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EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer II - GovSpend

Oct 2023 - Present

<https://govspend.com>

- Pioneered LLM-assisted development workflows by building custom automation tools that reduced biweekly release preparation from 1-2 hours to minutes and guided engineers through high-quality RFC writing, dramatically improving team productivity.
- Elevated engineering standards by establishing formal processes for technical design (RFCs) and deployments.
- Guided company-wide LLM adoption by researching models for cost and quality, implementing an optimized prompt engineering strategy to generate summaries for over 1 million meetings.
- Delivered 99% database storage reduction through targeted data cleanup and schema optimization, and led migration to Temporal Cloud.
- Rapidly developed a semantic search proof-of-concept using Voyage.AI and Elasticsearch, leveraging LLM-assisted development to quickly showcase the feature's value.

Senior Software Engineer - Kevel (formerly Adzerk)

Nov 2014 - Sep 2023

<https://kevel.com>

- Key engineer during growth from 10 to 150+ employees; implemented high-performance ad engines and APIs, oversaw campaign management UI evolution.
- Won high-profile enterprise customers by overhauling authentication to support SSO (SAML, OIDC) and implementing Content Security Policy, raising Mozilla Observatory score from F to A.
- Led technical design processes, mentored dozens of engineers, and streamlined feature delivery with CI/CD pipelines.

Disability Examiner / ODAR Specialist - NC Disability Determination Services

Aug 2008 - Nov 2014

- Determined eligibility for Social Security disability by analyzing complex medical and vocational records, managing a demanding caseload while serving as the sole liaison for federal hearings offices.

EDUCATION

University of North Carolina - Chapel Hill

2004 - 2008

Bachelor's degree - Music Composition and Bassoon Performance

PROJECTS

Alda

2012 - present

<https://github.com/alda-lang/alda>

- Popular open-source project (5,000+ GitHub stars), featured on HackerNews
- Presented at international conferences, including ICFP, Compose Conference, and Strange Loop

SKILLS

Technical design: Distributed architecture, Domain-Driven Design, SDLC, testing approaches

People: Onboarding, leading, mentoring, documentation, creative problem solving, planning and prioritization, collaboration with stakeholders

AI: Prompt engineering, semantic search, Langchain, Langfuse, LLM-assisted development

Backend: Temporal, Go, TypeScript, Node.js, Clojure, Java, C#, REST APIs

Frontend: TypeScript, React, JavaScript, XState, UX design, SSO, SAML, OIDC, ClojureScript

Databases: Relational databases (SQL Server, PostgreSQL), NoSQL / document databases (MongoDB, Elasticsearch, Redis, DynamoDB)

DevOps: Linux, Bash, Git, Amazon Web Services (AWS), Google Cloud Platform (GCP), Datadog, monitoring, logging, telemetry, observability, continuous integration & delivery (CI/CD), standards compliance